PHISHING DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

1. Introduction

Phishing is a form of cyber attack where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, banking details, or personal data. These attacks often appear as legitimate emails from trusted organizations.

2. Objectives

- Identify phishing emails
- Analyze phishing techniques
- Educate users on prevention methods

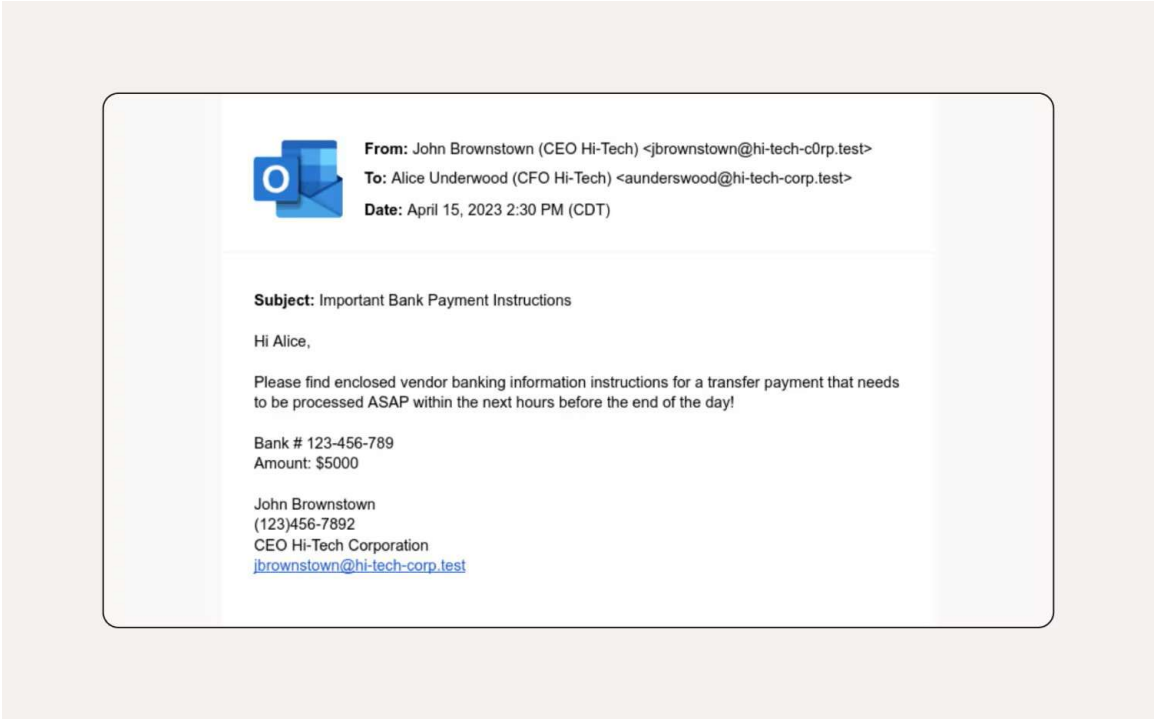
3. Methodology

This project involved analyzing sample phishing emails using browser tools and manual inspection. Key elements such as sender addresses, links, and language patterns were examined.

4. Phishing Indicators

- Spoofed sender addresses
- Suspicious or shortened links
- Urgent or threatening language
- Requests for sensitive information
- Poor grammar and formatting

5. Sample Email Analysis



From: John Brownstown (CEO Hi-Tech) <jbrownstown@hi-tech-c0rp.test>
To: Alice Underwood (CFO Hi-Tech) <aunderswood@hi-tech-corp.test>
Date: April 15, 2023 2:30 PM (CDT)

Subject: Important Bank Payment Instructions

Hi Alice,

Please find enclosed vendor banking information instructions for a transfer payment that needs to be processed ASAP within the next hours before the end of the day!

Bank # 123-456-789
Amount: $5000

John Brownstown
(123)456-7892
CEO Hi-Tech Corporation
jbrownstown@hi-tech-corp.test

Figure 1: Phishing Email

Classification: Phishing
Reasons: Urgent language, suspicious link, request for money

6. Detection Approach

A rule-based system was used to classify emails based on keywords and patterns such as urgency, links, and sensitive data requests.

7. Prevention Guidelines

- Do not click unknown links
- Verify sender identity
- Enable two-factor authentication
- Never share sensitive information

8. Conclusion

Phishing attacks remain a major threat, but user awareness and proper detection methods can significantly reduce risks.